



Student Attendance & Makeup Guide

Virginia University of Integrative Medicine Effective: Spring 2026

1. Purpose and How to Use This Guide

This guide provides VUIM clinic interns with clear, operational instructions for managing attendance and makeup shifts. It translates handbook policy into actionable steps to ensure compliance with clinical requirements. Use this guide to understand your responsibilities regarding punctuality, how to request makeups, and how to verify authorization to attend a shift.

2. Core Attendance Expectations

Clinical training at VUIM requires **100% attendance**. Clinic shifts represent professional commitments to patient care; reliability is a cornerstone of East Asian Medicine (EAM) practice.

- Interns must be present, prepared, and in the correct attire for the entire duration of their assigned shift.
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3. Tardiness

Arrival timing is strictly monitored. Supervisors are required to record your exact arrival time in Populi for every shift.

- **1 to 30 Minutes Late:** Recorded as a "Tardy."
- **First Tardy:** May be converted to an excused tardy if you arrive on time for all remaining shifts in the quarter.

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- **Second Tardy:** Results in a written warning and automatic forfeiture of treatment credits for that shift.
 - **Cumulative Tardiness:** Repeated tardiness may result in further disciplinary action as outlined in the Handbook.
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4. Absences

Any arrival after 30 minutes, or a missed shift, is recorded as an "Absence."

- **30 to 44 Minutes Late:** Recorded as an "Absence." You may remain for the shift if permitted by the supervisor, but no treatment credits will be awarded for that shift.
 - **45 Minutes or More Late:** Recorded as an "Absence." You may not participate in the shift. You must leave the clinic and make up the shift.
 - **Notification:** If you will be absent and do not already have approved makeup authorization through the DCE Office, you must notify your supervisor and copy the DCE by email before the start of the shift.
 - **Unexcused Absence:** An absence without prior notification to your supervisor and without an approved makeup request is classified as an unexcused absence. This is treated as patient abandonment and carries serious disciplinary consequences: a first offense results in a three-week suspension from the clinic; a second offense results in suspension from the clinic for the entire quarter.
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5. Makeup Requests

All missed shifts—including those due to excused absences, emergencies, or school closures—must be made up within the same quarter.

- **Submission:** Submit the [Makeup Request Form](#) (Populi → Links) at least one week prior to the missed shift or the intended makeup date, whichever is earlier.
- **The "First Absence" Rule:** Only the first excused absence **per course, per quarter** allows participation in a makeup shift with full treatment credit eligibility.

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- **Multiple Absences:** More than one excused absence per course, per quarter forfeits treatment credits for those makeup shifts. Additional documentation or a legitimate excuse does not override this rule unless a formal institutional exception is granted.
 - **School Closures:** Shifts missed due to school closures must be made up, but they do not count toward your excused absence allowance.
 - **Intensive Session:** No makeup shifts are permitted during the Intensive session. Do not register for a clinical course if you anticipate missing any shifts during this period.
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6. How Approval Actually Works

Approval is not assumed. Submitting a request does not authorize you to attend a makeup shift.

- **Authority:** Approval is granted only by the **DCE Office**.
 - **Capacity:** Makeup spots are limited, typically to two interns per shift. If a shift is full on the Live Clinic Schedule (LCS), your request will be denied.
 - **No Independent Authorization:** Clinical supervisors do not have the authority to approve or allow makeup shifts. Only the DCE Office can formally approve them.
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7. How to Verify a Makeup Was Approved

It is your responsibility to confirm approval before arriving at the clinic.

- **LCS Blue Section:** The **blue Makeup section** of the Live Clinic Schedule (LCS) is the authoritative operational source for all approved makeup scheduling. If your name and the approved date are listed there, you are authorized.
 - **Populi Confirmation Channel:** You will receive an automated Populi email confirmation once a request is processed. To review the details, click **View Form** within that confirmation.
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8. What to Do on the Makeup Shift

1. **Check-In:** Notify the supervisor immediately upon arrival that you are there for an approved makeup.
 2. **Assignment:** The supervisor will place you into an existing single-intern group or a designated "Makeup Group."
 3. **Engagement:** You must remain on-site and actively engaged for the full shift. If no patients are seen, you must participate in supervisor-led clinical learning activities.
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9. Hours, Treatment Credit, and Participation

- **Hours:** Attendance hours may be credited when you attend the full shift, remain actively engaged as directed, and properly document the shift in your Clinical Diary.
 - **Treatment Credit:** Earned only through **active participation** in an intern role (Lead or Assistant).
 - **No Patients:** If no patients are seen, you do not earn treatment credits for that shift.
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10. Clinical Diary Documentation

Your Clinical Diary is the primary shift-level record of your attendance and activity.

- **Signatures:** You must obtain a supervisor's signature at the end of **every** shift, including makeups.
 - **"No Patients":** If no patients were treated, write "No Patients" in the Clinical Diary. This ensures you receive credit for hours attended.
 - **Resolution:** To change an "Absent" status to "Excused," you must show the signed Clinical Diary entry from your makeup shift to your original supervisor.
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11. Incomplete Grade and Rare Exceptions

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An "Incomplete" (I) grade is a rare exception for documented emergencies or school closures.

- **Eligibility:** Generally only available if **60%** of the clinical course has been completed.
 - **Usage:** It should not be relied upon for normal scheduling or non-emergency absences.
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12. Common Mistakes and FAQs

The "I Sent the Form" Mistake: Submitting a request does not equal approval. You must wait for the Populi "View Form" confirmation and verify your name on the LCS before attending.

The "Supervisor Said Yes" Mistake: A supervisor cannot approve or allow a makeup shift independently. Formal DCE approval is required.

The "No Patients" Mistake: Leaving early because there are no patients. You must stay for the full shift to earn hour credit.

What if I know in advance that I will miss a shift? Submit a Makeup Request Form through Populi at least one week before the missed shift or the requested makeup shift, whichever is earlier.

What if I had an emergency and missed a shift? Notify your supervisor and copy the DCE as soon as possible. Submit a Makeup Request Form with supporting documentation.

What if I am 10 or 25 minutes late? This is a Tardy. You may participate in the shift. See Section 3 for tardy escalation and consequences.

What if I am 35 minutes late? This is an Absence. You may remain only if permitted by the supervisor, but you will not earn treatment credits for that shift.

What if I am 50 minutes late? This is an Absence. You may not participate in the shift and must make up the shift.

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What if I already used my one excused absence for this course this quarter? Any additional missed shifts must still be made up. Additional excused absences result in treatment-credit forfeiture for those makeup shifts and may carry further consequences.

What if my request was submitted but I do not yet see approval? Approval is not assumed. Wait for the processed Populi response and verify the approved shift on the LCS before attending.

What if my Populi response shows approval but I do not yet see it on the LCS? Contact the DCE Office before attempting to attend the shift. Do not rely on the processed response alone.

What if I completed my makeup shift? Get your Clinical Diary signed and show the signed entry to your original supervisor so the original absence can be updated to Excused.

What if I attended a makeup shift and there were no patients? Remain on-site and engaged in assigned clinical learning. Document "No Patients" in the Clinical Diary and obtain the supervisor's signature.

What if the school closed due to weather or another campus-wide reason? The shift must still be made up, but it does not count toward your excused absence allowance.

What if I think I may need an Incomplete? Incompletes are rare and may be considered only for documented emergencies or school closures, generally only if at least 60% of the course has been completed.

What if I am an observer, not an intern? Observers must still meet attendance requirements and make up missed shifts. Standard observation does not earn treatment credits.

What if I came to a shift without formal approval? Attendance at an unapproved makeup shift does not count toward makeup completion. Additionally, the underlying absence may be classified as unexcused, which carries serious disciplinary consequences. See Section 4.

13. Key Takeaways

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- **1 to 30 mins** = Tardy; second tardy = written warning and treatment credit forfeiture.
 - **30 to 44 mins** = Absence (no treatment credit).
 - **45 minutes or more** = Absence; you may not participate and must make up the shift.
 - **Unexcused absence** = patient abandonment; first offense results in a three-week clinic suspension.
 - **DCE Office** is the only approval authority; **LCS Blue Section** is the authoritative schedule.
 - **"One excused absence per course, per quarter"** is the standard for absence limits.
 - **Clinical Diary signatures** are required every shift, regardless of patient volume.
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14. Disclaimer

The Student Clinic Handbook remains the formal authority on all VUIM policies. In the event of a conflict between this guide and the Handbook (as updated by official University memos), the Handbook shall govern.

Questions? Contact the DCE Office: dce@vuim.edu

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